

LIVING STONES

Lithops spp.

This is a truly weird and wonderful plant, full of surprises and sensory stimulation. The soft, padded leaves are covered with mottled green or reddish tones, with a margin of gray or brown. As a kid, I thought it looked more like little brains than the “living stones” of its name!

“My bizarre appearance will amaze and delight.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Needs 5–6 hours of direct sunlight a day, so place in a sunny spot on a south-facing windowsill. Also prefers low humidity so keep somewhere dry.



POTTING

Lithops hardly ever needs repotting, but if the plant becomes crowded, wait until late spring and use a cactus compost mixed with grit.



GROWTH RATE

These are very slow-growing plants, reaching no more than 1½in (3cm) tall by 1½in (3cm) wide at their maximum size.



CARE

Do not water at all from early fall to midspring. The rest of the year, soak it every 2 weeks, letting it fully dry out between waterings.



I'm one of a kind

I don't look like any other houseplant. I am such an interesting shape and color, I'll inspire a real sense of wonder at the variety of Mother Nature, taking your mind away from the stresses and pressures of everyday life.



Get to know me

My Latin name is derived from the Ancient Greek term *lithos*, which means “stone,” and *ops*, which means “face,” referring to my stonelike appearance. You can buy me as a small plant or grow me from seeds, which form when my flower dies back and the seed pod ripens.

